

KRISTINA M. FULLERTON RICO

(surname: Fullerton Rico | pronouns: she/her)

Center for Racial Justice, Ford School of Public Policy
University of Michigan

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EDUCATION

- 2024 UNIVERSITY OF WISCONSIN–MADISON
Ph.D., Sociology
Dissertation: *Transnational Undocumented Aging: Challenges Faced By Mexico–U.S. Migrants In Later Life*
Committee: Jenna Nobles (chair), Myra Marx Ferree, Theodore P. Gerber, Katherine Jensen, Almita Miranda (Geography, Chican@ & Latin@ Studies)
- 2019 UNIVERSITY OF WISCONSIN–MADISON
M.S., Sociology
Thesis: *“Unos Allá, Otros Aquí:” Transnational Parenting and Digital Communication across the Mexico–U.S. Border*
Comprehensive Exams: 1) Gender and 2) Ethnography
- 2011 REED COLLEGE
B.A., Sociology

PUBLICATIONS

Fullerton Rico, Kristina. 2023. [“Grieving in the ‘Golden Cage’: How Unauthorized Immigrants Contend with Death and Mourn from Afar.”](#) *Social Problems*.

Fullerton Rico, Kristina M. 2025. “Book Review: *When Care is Conditional: Immigrants and the U.S. Safety Net* by Dani Carrillo.” *Gender & Society*.

IN PREPARATION

Fullerton Rico, Kristina M. *They Would Have Been Americans: How Older Undocumented Immigrants and Their Mixed-Status, Transnational Families Endure Immigrant Exclusion*. (Book proposal and manuscript in progress.)

Fullerton Rico, Kristina M., Aransa Hidaly Sanchez, Laura Enriquez. "Grief Across Borders: (Im)mobility and Mourning in Mixed-Status Families."

Fullerton Rico, Kristina M. "Sea como sea, son hermanos': How Transnational Parents Encourage Bonds between Siblings Separated by the Mexico–U.S. Border."

Fullerton Rico, Kristina M. "Feminist Interview Methods and Ethnographic Research Ethics."

AWARDS, GRANTS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

2024–	Postdoctoral Fellowship, Center for Racial Justice, Ford School of Public Policy, University of Michigan (Funded)
2024	Ford School Winter 2024 Honor Roll for Excellent Teaching
2023	Ford School Fall 2023 Honor Roll for Excellent Teaching
2023–2024	Predoctoral Fellowship, Center for Racial Justice, Ford School of Public Policy, University of Michigan (Funded)
2022	Dissertation Research Grant, Russell Sage Foundation (Funded)
2021–2023	Migration Fellow, Penn-Birmingham Transatlantic Migration Fellowship
2021–2022	Advanced Opportunity Fellowship, UW–Madison (Funded)
2021	Honorable Mention Award, Sociologists for Women in Society (SWS) Esther Ngan-ling Chow and Maryjoyce Green Dissertation Scholarship (Funded)
2020	Honored Instructor, UW–Madison, Spring 2020
2019–2021	Graduate Research Fellowship, Institute for Research on Poverty, UW–Madison (Funded)
2019	Honored Instructor, UW–Madison, Fall 2019
2018	Chi Omega Honored Professor, UW-Madison
2016–2017	Advanced Opportunity Fellowship, UW-Madison (Funded)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2025 ASA Annual Meeting, Regular Session (Latinas, Latinos, Latinx Section): Identity, Work, and Family: Latinos in the US and Beyond.
Presentation Title: *Grief Across Borders: (Im)mobility and Mourning in Mixed-Status Families.*
- 2025 ASA Annual Meeting, Roundtable (Section on Aging and the Life Course): Social Relationships Over the Life Course.
Presentation Title: *How U.S. Immigration Policies Drive Out Undocumented Grandparents and Restructure Mixed-Status Families.*
- 2024 ASA Annual Meeting, Regular Session: Older Adults, Structures, and Agency
Presentation Title: *Retirement or Exile?: Return Migration Due to Undocumented Status in Later Life.*
- 2022 ASA Annual Meeting, Regular Session (International Migration Section): Immigration and Immigration Policy: Implications for Mental Health.
Presentation Title: *Grieving in the "Golden Cage": How Unauthorized Immigrants Mourn from Afar.*
- 2022 Chicago Ethnography Conference, Migration Panel.
Presentation Title: *How Undocumented Status Complicates Mourning.*
- 2022 Boston Migration Workshop Work-in-Progress Workshop:
Presentation Title: *"The Price We Pay": How Unauthorized Immigrants Endure Transnational Grieving.*
- 2021 ASA Annual Meeting, Global and Transnational Sociology Roundtable on Migration and Transnationalism.
Presentation Title: *"The Price We Pay": Transnational Mourning and Transforming Disenfranchised Grief.*
- 2021 Midwest Sociological Society Annual Meeting, Session on Emotions, Emotion Work, and Emotion Management
Presentation Title: *Transnational Death and Strategies for Mourning from Afar.*
- 2021 Sociologists for Women in Society Winter Meeting, Roundtable on Positionality, Research & Qualitative Methods.
Presentation Title: *Using Interviews to Address Unequal Power Dynamics and Increase Transparency in Fieldwork.*

- 2020 Midwest Sociological Society Annual Meeting*
Presentation Title: *“Unos Allá, Otros Aquí”: Transnational Parenting and Digital Communication across the Mexico-U.S. Border.*
- 2019 Sociologists for Women in Society Summer Meeting, Roundtable on Gender, Migration, and Identity.
Presentation Title: *Gendered Motherhood Ideals and Intra-Familial Inequality in a Mexico–U.S. Context.*
- 2019 Chicago Ethnography Conference
Presentation Title: *Aquí y Allá: Transnational Parenting and Digital Communication across the Mexico–U.S. Border.*
- 2018 Chicago Ethnography Conference
Presentation Title: *Separated by the Border: Mexico-U.S. Transnational Families in the Trump Era.*

* Canceled due to the COVID-19 pandemic

RESEARCH AND TEACHING INTERESTS

Migration, Aging, Gender, Family, Qualitative Methods, Latine Studies, Race and Ethnicity, Social Movements

TEACHING POSITIONS

- 2025 University of Michigan, Ford School of Public Policy (Sole Instructor)
Lecturer, U.S. Immigration Policy (graduate seminar, PUBPOL 677)
- 2024 University of Michigan, Department of Sociology (Sole Instructor)
Lecturer, Transnational Families (SOC 295)
- 2024 University of Michigan, Ford School of Public Policy (Sole Instructor)
Lecturer, U.S. Immigration Policy (graduate seminar, PUBPOL 677)
- 2023 University of Michigan, Ford School of Public Policy (Sole Instructor)
Lecturer, Latinx Social Movements in the U.S. (combined undergraduate and graduate seminar, PUBPOL 475, PUBPOL 750)

2019–2020	UW–Madison, Chican@/Latin@ Studies Program (Sole Instructor) Lecturer, Introduction to Chican@/Latin@ Studies (CHICLA 201)
2019	UW–Madison, Sociology Department Teaching Assistant, Population Problems (SOC 170)
2017–2018	UW–Madison, Sociology Department Teaching Assistant, Sociology of Gender (SOC 138)

RESEARCH POSITIONS

2024–	University of Michigan, Ford School of Public Policy Center for Racial Justice Postdoctoral Fellow
2023–2024	University of Michigan, Ford School of Public Policy Center for Racial Justice Predoctoral Fellow
2020	UW–Madison, Sociology Department Research Assistant to Prof. Jenna Nobles <i>Oversaw a research team of six students to transcribe, digitize, and code archival Mexico–U.S. migration data</i>

INVITED TALKS AND GUEST LECTURES

2025	Latinx Law Student Association, University of Michigan Law School: “Latinx Perspectives on Immigration Law and Policy” (panel with Prof. Luis C.deBaca and Andrea R. Flores)
2025	Inequality and Social Demography Workshop: “Disposable Grandparents: How U.S. Immigration Policies Drive Out Undocumented Grandparents and Restructure Mixed-Status Families” University of Michigan
2024	Ford School Faculty Research Seminar: “Separated Generations: How Immigrant

Exclusion Impacts Older Adults and Reshapes Families”
University of Michigan

- 2024 Roundtable Q&A with Students in the Chicano/Latino Studies and Sociology
Departments
University of California–Irvine
- 2021 Ethnic Social Movements in the United States (SOC 220)
University of Wisconsin–Madison, Sociology Department
- 2021 Marriage and the Family (SOC 120)
University of Wisconsin–Madison, Sociology Department
- 2019 Sociology of Gender (SOC 138)
University of Wisconsin–Madison, Sociology Department

UNIVERSITY AND DEPARTMENT SERVICE

- 2025 University of Michigan
SROP
- 2024–2025 University of Michigan
Rackham RAF
- 2022–2023 University of Wisconsin–Madison, Sociology Department
Qualitative Methods Workshop
Discussant
- 2020–2022 University of Wisconsin–Madison, Sociology Department
Website Committee Member
- 2019–2022 22nd Annual Chicago Ethnography Conference**
Organizing Committee Member
- 2017 University of Wisconsin–Madison, Sociology Department,
Solidarity Support Group for Graduate Students of Color
Co-chair

2017–2020	University of Wisconsin–Madison, Sociology Graduate Mentoring Mentor
2016–2018	University of Wisconsin–Madison, PASOS, Chican@ Latin@ Studies Mentor for Chican@ Latin@ Students
2016–2017	University of Wisconsin–Madison, Sociology Department, Teaching Race Workshop Co-organizer

** Originally scheduled for 2021, postponed due to the COVID-19 pandemic

SERVICE TO PROFESSION

Reviewer

Social Forces

International Migration Journal

PUBLIC SOCIOLOGY (OP-EDS, NEWS ARTICLES, MEDIA APPEARANCES)

Fullerton Rico, Kristina. 2025. "Deportation fears create ripple effects for immigrants and their communities." *The Conversation*. 19 February.

<https://theconversation.com/deportation-fears-create-ripple-effects-for-immigrants-and-their-communities-248817>

Fullerton Rico, Kristina and William D. Lopez. "To stop bird flu, Michigan must protect farmworkers." *Bridge Michigan*. 8 July. <https://bridgemi.com/author/kristina-fullerton-rico/>

Langfellow, Tony. 2021. "Breaking language barriers for COVID-19 vaccine info." CBS affiliate, WSAW–TV.

<https://www.wsaw.com/2021/08/13/breaking-language-barriers-covid-19-vaccine-info/>

López, Jane Lilly and Kristina Fullerton Rico. 2024. "How Biden's executive order to protect immigrant spouses of citizens from deportation would benefit their families and communities." *The Conversation*. June 18.

<https://theconversation.com/how-bidens-executive-order-to-protect-immigrant-spouses-of-citizens-from-deportation-will-benefit-their-families-and-communities-231651>

Napoleon, Davi. 2025. "Target: Immigrants." March 25.

<https://annarborobserver.com/target-immigrants/>

Rohrlic, Justin. 2025. "Prison chaplain at ICE facility in Pennsylvania accused of sexually abusing immigration detainee." September 1.

<https://www.the-independent.com/news/world/americas/ice-immigration-prison-chaplain-abuse-lawsuit-b2816820.html>

Sun, Alice. 2024. "Easing the Toll of Long-Distance Grief." *Yes! Magazine*, April 30.
<https://www.yesmagazine.org/health-happiness/2024/04/30/death-distance-grief-immigration>

Sun, Alice. Translated by Kristina Fullerton Rico. 2024. "Cómo Apoyar a Las Personas Que Enfrentan el Duelo a Larga Distancia." *Yes! Magazine*, April 30.
<https://www.yesmagazine.org/health-happiness/2024/10/23/apoyar-duelo-distancia-larga>

The World. ABC News (Australia). 2025. "Donald Trump's deportation push picks up steam." April 15.
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4-3tuW22kdE>

LANGUAGES

English (fluent), Spanish (native speaker)